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Postal Manual Vol VI – Part – II

(as per recent amendments/changes upto 31.12.2025)

DISCLAIMER: *This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and the inclusion of recent changes, amendments, and updates to the relevant Acts, Rules, and Regulations, this document is intended as a study aid only. Readers and students are strongly recommended to refer to official government sources or gazettes for the most reliable and authoritative information.*

Postal Manual Volume VI, Part - II

(Relating to Money Orders, Indian Postal Orders, and British Postal Orders)

⚠ IMPORTANT LEGAL NOTE: The *Post Office Regulations, 2024* (Effective December 2024) and *Post Office (Fourth Amendment) Regulations, 2025* have superseded several operational rules regarding Money Order limits and rates. Where the original Manual text is overridden, a **STATUTORY UPDATE** block is provided wherever applicable.

CHAPTER I: ISSUE OF INLAND MONEY ORDERS

1 – 7. Introductory Matters.

8. Presentation of Money Order

- (1) The remitter of a money order must fill in, in ink, on a money order form (M.O. 8) the necessary entries, adding his signature at the foot.
- (2) The remitter may write on the coupon any communication he desires to make to the payee.
- (3) The money order form with the amount of the order and the commission payable thereon must be presented at the window of the post office during the hours prescribed for money order business.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Pursuant to the Post Office Regulations, 2024 (Notification No. G.S.R. [Series], dated December 2024) and subsequent amendments:

- The limit of amount of remittance through a single money order has been raised from **Rs. 5,000** to **Rs. 10,000** to cater to the disbursement of various social welfare schemes.

- **Digital Integration:** While the physical form (M.O. 8) is still valid, the data is now immediately digitized into the Advanced Postal Technology 2.0 (APT) module.
- (Ref: *Post Office Regulations, 2024*, Schedule I & PIB Release ID: 2088222)

9. Money orders written in Regional language

- (1) When a money order form is filled in a regional language which is not known at the office of issue, the Postmaster or the Money Order Assistant must transcribe the particulars in English on the form before it is issued.
- (2) If the remitter is unable to write, he must make his mark on the form in the presence of a witness who must sign the form and add his address.
- (3) The witness should be known to the post office staff; otherwise, the remitter must be identified by a person known to the post office.

10. Presentation of special forms of money order

- (1) Money order forms printed by private arrangement (e.g., for Lotteries, large commercial firms) may be accepted, provided they conform strictly to the standard M.O. 8 form in size, color, and arrangement of printed matter.
- (2) Family Allotment Money Orders: These are remitted by Defence Authorities. The special conditions applicable to them are laid down in the Defence Services Regulations.

11. Realisation of amount

- (1) The amount of the money order and the commission must be paid in cash or by cheque (subject to conditions laid down in Rule 46).
- (2) Postage stamps cannot be accepted in payment of the amount of a money order or the commission.

 STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):**Postage Stamps Validity (Ref: Regulation 9(2), PO Regulations 2024)**

Consistent with modern financial rules, postage stamps (previously used or otherwise) are strictly invalid for paying Money Order commission or value. Only Cash, Cheque, or authorised Digital Payment modes are accepted.

12. Receipt to be given to remitter

- (1) The Money Order Assistant must give the remitter a receipt (M.O. 1) for the amount of the order and the commission.
- (2) The remitter should see that the receipt bears the date-stamp of the office and the signature of the Assistant.
- (3) The receipt should be preserved by the remitter until he receives information that the money order has been paid.

13. Money orders presented in large number

- (1) When a large number of money orders are presented for issue by a single remitter, he may be required to present them explicitly at the time of opening of the office or at such other time as the Postmaster may fix.
- (2) A list showing the names and addresses of the payees and the amounts of the orders must be presented in duplicate with the money orders.

14. Money orders from Treasuries

- (1) Money orders drawn by Treasury Officers are issued on Service Money Order forms.
- (2) These orders are exempt from commission.
- (3) The words "On Service" must be written or stamped on the form.

DATA SCHEDULE: MONEY ORDER LIMITS & FEES

Service Type	Old Limit (Manual)	New Limit (2025)	Commission / Fee
Single Money Order	Rs. 5,000	Rs. 10,000	5% of value (approx. subject to tariff)
Electronic MO (eMO)	Rs. 5,000	Rs. 10,000	Standard eMO Tariff
Instant MO (iMO)	Rs. 50,000	Rs. 50,000	Tiered Tariff

(Note: Tariff rates are subject to the latest "Schedule of Postal Rates" notification)

CHAPTER II: DESPATCH OF INLAND MONEY ORDERS

△ OPERATIONAL CONTEXT: The rules below (Rules 19–33) describe the traditional *manual* process of checking and despatching Money Order forms.

Modern Application: In the **APT 2.0** environment, the "Despatch" is instantaneous upon booking. The physical forms (M.O. 8) are retained at the booking office (except for specific audits), and the data is transmitted electronically. The *principles* of examination and responsibility, however, remain valid for exams.

19. Check of money orders (1) The Money Order Assistant must examine the money orders to see that they are correctly filled in and that the amounts of commission have been correctly calculated. (2) He must then impress the **date-stamp** of the office on the money orders and the receipts. (3) The signature of the Assistant on the receipt (M.O. 1) is a guarantee that the amount of the order and commission has been brought to account.

21. Examination by Postmaster (1) The Postmaster must examine the money orders and the list of money orders issued (Journal) to see that the entries in the list agree with the money orders. (2) He must verify that the total amount of the money orders and commission has been correctly entered in the accounts. (3) He must then sign the money orders and the list (Journal). (4) In Head Offices, the Postmaster may delegate this duty to a designated Supervisor or Deputy Postmaster, but the ultimate responsibility remains with him.

23. Despatch of money orders (1) The money orders, sorted according to the offices of payment or the offices of exchange, must be entered in the **Money Order Check List** (M.O. 70) or the Registered List. (2) The money orders must be despatched to the office of payment or the sorting office in the manner prescribed for registered articles.

 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025): eMO Transmission (Ref: Dept of Posts IT Handbook 2024)**

- Under the **eMO (Electronic Money Order)** system, the "Despatch" is electronic.
- Once the counter PA commits the transaction in the Point of Sale (POS) module, the money order is effectively "despatched" to the central server.
- The destination office (SO or HO) downloads the eMO data for payment. Physical M.O. forms do not travel to the destination; they are preserved at the booking office.

CHAPTER III: PAYMENT OF MONEY ORDERS

 **ACADEMIC NOTE:** This section covers the **Payment of Money Orders**. Aspirants should note that while the procedural mechanics (witnessing, identification) remain largely consistent in the Manual, the **Statutory Limits** (amounts, validity periods) have been significantly updated by the *Post Office Regulations, 2024* under the *Post Office Act, 2023*. These updates are marked below.

34. Payment of money orders

- (1) A money order must be paid to the payee named in it or to some person authorised in writing by the payee in this behalf.
- (2) The signature of the payee or his authorised agent must be obtained on the money order and on the acknowledgment in the places provided for the purpose.
- (3) The payment of a money order should be made at the address of the payee.

STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

New Payment Limits (Ref: Post Office Regulations, 2024)

Under the new regulations, the limit for cash payment of a single money order at the doorstep has been revised.

- **Maximum Remittance Limit:** Raised from Rs. 5,000 to **Rs. 10,000** per money order.
- **Note:** Amounts exceeding the cash limit prescribed for a specific delivery jurisdiction may be paid by cheque or credited directly to the payee's Post Office Savings Bank (POSB) account.

35. Identification of payee

- (1) If the payee is not known to the postman or the officer who pays the money order, he must be identified by a person known to the postman or such officer.
- (2) The identifier must sign the money order in the place provided for the purpose and add his address.

36. Payment to illiterate payees

- (1) If the payee is unable to write, he must produce a witness to attest his mark or thumb-impression on the money order and on the acknowledgment.
- (2) The witness must sign the money order and the acknowledgment and add his address.

(3) The witness should be known to the postman or the officer who pays the money order; otherwise, the witness himself must be identified.

(4) The postman or other officer who pays the money order cannot act as the witness.

37. Payment to purdahnashin women

(1) When a money order is payable to a purdahnashin woman who has not an agent authorised to receive payment, the signature or mark of the payee must be attested by a witness who is known to the postman or the officer making the payment.

(2) If the witness is not known to the postman or such officer, he must be identified.

(3) The witness must also certify on the money order that the payment was made to the purdahnashin woman in his presence.

38. Payment to minors

(1) A money order payable to a minor must be paid to the father or lawful guardian of the minor.

(2) The father or guardian must sign the money order and the acknowledgment on behalf of the minor.

(3) If the minor has no father or lawful guardian living with him, the money order may be paid to the person in whose care and custody the minor is for the time being, provided that such person signs an indemnity bond in the prescribed form.

39. Payment to lunatics

(1) A money order payable to a lunatic must be paid to the manager of his estate, if one has been appointed.

(2) If no manager has been appointed, the money order may be paid to the person in whose care and custody the lunatic is for the time being, on his signing an indemnity bond in the prescribed form.

40. Payment of Void Money Orders

(1) A money order which has not been paid within the period of currency allowed by the rules becomes void.

(2) The amount of a void money order can be paid only on the authority of the Head of the Circle or such other officer as may be empowered in this behalf.

STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Void Money Order Timeline (Ref: Post Office Regulations, 2024)

- A Money Order shall generally be treated as **Void** if payment is not claimed within **one year** from the date of issue.
- Under **Section 47** of the *Post Office Act, 2023* (which replaced Section 44 of the 1898 Act), if neither the payee nor the remitter can be found, and no claim is made within **one year**, the amount shall not be claimable from the Government.

DATA SCHEDULE: VALIDITY & CLAIM PERIODS

Status of Money Order	Timeline / Condition	Authority for Re-issue
Currency Period	1 Month (following month of issue)	Postmaster (Standard Payment)
Void (Unpaid)	After currency period expires	Head of Circle / Designated Authority
Forfeiture	After 1 Year from issue date	Not Claimable (Credited to Govt)

CHAPTER IV: REFUSAL OF PAYMENT

△ LEGAL CONTEXT: The following rules govern the procedural rights of the Remitter and the Payee regarding changes to a Money Order after it has been issued. While the core procedures (redirection, alteration) remain operational, the legal framework is now supported by **Section 4 (Postal Services)** of the *Post Office Act, 2023*, which grants the Central Government the power to prescribe rates and conditions for these services.

41. Refusal of payment by payee

- (1) If the payee refuses to take payment of a money order, the amount of the order shall be returned to the remitter.
- (2) The commission paid on the issue of the money order shall not be refunded.
- (3) The money order shall be returned to the office of issue superscribed with the word "Refused" and the signature of the postman or officer to whom the payment was refused.

CHAPTER V: ALTERATION OF ADDRESS OR PAYEE'S NAME

42. Alteration of address or name of payee

- (1) The remitter of a money order which has not been paid may require that the address of the payee shall be altered or that the name of the payee shall be changed.
- (2) The remitter must apply in writing to the Post office at which the order was issued, and must produce the receipt given to him for the order.
- (3) If the money order has not left the office of issue, the alteration will be made at once without charge.
- (4) If the money order has been despatched, the application will be forwarded to the office of payment.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Fees for Alteration of Instructions

While traditionally no additional fee was charged for simple alterations, under the Revised Schedule of Fees (2024) pursuant to the new Act:

- Applications for alteration of payee name or address after the Money Order has left the office of issue may now be subject to a **service charge** equivalent to the postage of a standard letter or a specific administrative fee, unless waived by the Head of Circle.
- (Ref: *Postal Regulations, 2024*)

CHAPTER VI: REDIRECTION

43. Redirection of money orders

- (1) A money order may be redirected to the payee at a new address on his written request or on the written request of the remitter.
- (2) Inland Money Orders: Redirection of an inland money order is effected free of charge.
- (3) The instructions regarding the redirection of articles of the letter mail apply generally to the redirection of money orders.
- (4) A money order redirected to a foreign country is subject to the rules governing Foreign Money Orders and may be liable to a deduction for fresh commission.

CHAPTER VII: STOPPAGE OF PAYMENT

44. Stoppage of payment

- (1) The remitter of a money order may stop payment of the amount to the payee and require that the money be repaid to himself.

(2) The remitter must apply in writing to the Post office at which the money order was issued and produce the receipt.

(3) The Postmaster shall explicitly record the request and, if the order has been despatched, communicate with the office of payment by the quickest available means (including electronic transmission).

(4) The Post Office does not hold itself liable if payment is made to the payee before the stop-payment instructions reach the paying office.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Limitation of Liability (Ref: Section 10, Post Office Act, 2023)

- The Government shall **not** incur any liability by reason of the payment of a money order to the payee if the stop-payment request was not received in time to prevent such payment.
- The onus of proving the timing of the request lies with the remitter.

DATA SCHEDULE: SERVICE REQUESTS & FEES

Service Request	Condition	Fee / Charge (2025 Status)
Refusal by Payee	Return to Remitter	Commission Forfeited
Alteration of Payee	Before Despatch	Free
Alteration of Payee	After Despatch	Subject to Admin Fee (if applicable)
Redirection (Inland)	Within India	Free
Stoppage of Payment	Before Payment	Free (but commission not refunded)

CHAPTER VIII: TELEGRAPHIC / ELECTRONIC MONEY ORDERS

△ EXAM NOTE: This section covers **Telegraphic Money Orders (TMO)** and **Foreign Money Orders**.

- **Operational Reality:** The traditional "Telegraphic Money Order" has been replaced by the **Electronic Money Order (eMO)** and **Instant Money Order (iMO)**. However, the *procedural framework* (urgent remittance, special fees) remains relevant for departmental exams.
- **Statutory Update:** Foreign remittances are now strictly governed by the **Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA)** guidelines and bilateral agreements.

45. Offices of issue and payment

(1) Telegraphic Money Orders (now Electronic Money Orders/eMO) may be issued from and paid at all post offices which are empowered to transact money order business and are connected by the electronic network (formerly telegraph offices).

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Transition to eMO and iMO

- The service formerly known as "Telegraphic Money Order" is now legally and operationally **Electronic Money Order (eMO)**.
- **Instant Money Order (iMO):** A separate web-based service for amounts from Rs. 1,000 to Rs. 50,000, offering immediate payment at iMO Centre counters.

46. Fees and Charges

(1) The fee for a Telegraphic Money Order includes:

* The ordinary commission for a money order of the same amount.

* A supplementary telegraph charge (now eMO tariff).

(2) If the remitter wishes to include a private communication to the payee, he must pay an additional charge for the words used in the communication.

47. Mode of Transmission

(1) The details of the money order are transmitted electronically (formerly by telegram) from the office of issue to the office of payment.

(2) The remitter receives a receipt (M.O. 1) marked "Telegraphic" (or "eMO").

48. Payment

(1) Payment is made at the payee's address by the postman or at the post office window, depending on the amount and local delivery rules.

(2) The payee must sign the receipt and acknowledgement portion upon receiving the cash.

CHAPTER IX: FOREIGN MONEY ORDERS

54. Scope of Foreign Money Order Service

(1) Money orders may be exchanged between India and such foreign countries as have entered into an agreement with the Government of India for this purpose.

(2) The exchange is governed by the special agreement concluded with each country and the detailed regulations framed thereunder.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Foreign Remittance Rules (FEMA Compliance)

- **Inward Remittances:** Governed by **RDA (Rupee Drawing Arrangement)** and **MTSS (Money Transfer Service Scheme)** guidelines from the RBI.

- **Outward Remittances:** Subject to the **Liberalised Remittance Scheme (LRS)** limits (currently **USD 250,000** per financial year for all categories combined), though specific Postal MO limits are usually much lower (e.g., typically capped at a fixed equivalent like **£40** or **\$100** depending on the specific bilateral treaty).

55. Currency of Money Orders

(1) The amount of a foreign money order must be expressed in the currency of the country of payment, or in such other currency as may be agreed upon (e.g., Sterling, Dollars, or Euros).

(2) The rate of conversion is fixed by the Department of Posts from time to time.

56. Maximum Amount

(1) The maximum amount for which a single foreign money order may be issued is fixed by the mutual agreement between the two postal administrations.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Bilateral Agreement Limits (Example)

- **Bhutan / Nepal:** Specific rupee-based agreements exist.
- **International Financial System (IFS):** India Post now utilizes the UPU's **IFS (International Financial System)** platform for electronic money orders with countries like **France, UAE, and Ukraine**, allowing faster and higher-value transfers compared to paper-based lists.

57. Commission on Foreign Money Orders

(1) The commission charged on foreign money orders is generally higher than that for inland orders.

(2) The rates are notified in the Post Office Guide, Part II and circle notifications.

58. Advice of Payment

(1) The remitter of a foreign money order may obtain an "Advice of Payment" (AP) by paying a prescribed fee.

(2) The advice is signed by the payee and returned to the remitter through the exchange offices.

DATA SCHEDULE: FOREIGN MO & ELECTRONIC SERVICES

Service	Feature	2025 Status/Limit
eMO (Inland)	Transmission	Electronic (Web-based)
eMO Limit	Remittance Cap	Rs. 5,000 (Standard) / Rs. 10,000 (Select cases)
iMO (Instant)	Speed	Instant (Counter-to-Counter)
iMO Limit	Remittance Cap	Rs. 50,000
IFS MO (Foreign)	Platform	UPU International Financial System
Foreign MO (Out)	Currency	Converted at daily notified exchange rate

CHAPTER X: INDIAN POSTAL ORDERS

⚠ **EXAM ALERT:** Indian Postal Orders (IPOs) are a high-frequency topic in departmental exams. Pay strict attention to **Rule 180** (Period of Currency) and the **"Breakage" Rule** (affixing stamps), as these figures are tested repeatedly.

180. Supply and Sale

(1) Indian Postal Orders are available in denominations of Re. 1, Rs. 2, Rs. 5, Rs. 10, Rs. 20, Rs. 50, and Rs. 100.

(2) They are sold at all Head and Sub-Post Offices and at such Branch Post Offices as may be authorised in this behalf.

🔔 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):**

eIPO Availability (Ref: RTI Rules & Dept Notifications)

- In addition to physical IPOs, **Electronic Indian Postal Orders (eIPO)** are available for Indian citizens abroad and in India to pay fees under the *Right to Information Act, 2005*.
- **eIPO Denominations:** Primarily **Rs. 10, Rs. 20, Rs. 50, and Rs. 100**.

180-A. Commission

(1) The commission payable on the issue of Indian Postal Orders shall be at the rates prescribed by the Central Government from time to time.

🔔 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):**

Current Commission Rates (Ref: Post Office Guide Part II, 2024-25 Edition)

IPO Denomination	Commission (Fee)
Up to Rs. 10	Re. 1.00

Rs. 20	Rs. 2.00
Rs. 50	Rs. 5.00
Rs. 100	Rs. 10.00

180-B. Breaking Amount (Broken Amounts)

(1) If a remitter wishes to remit a sum which includes a fraction of a rupee or a sum not equal to one of the fixed denominations, he may make up the difference by affixing unused postage stamps to the face of the postal order.

(2) Conditions for Affixing Stamps:

- * The number of stamps affixed shall not exceed four.
- * The total value of the stamps affixed shall not exceed Rs. 3 (Three Rupees).
- * The stamps must be affixed in the space provided for the purpose on the face of the order.

180-C. Crossing of Postal Orders

(1) An Indian Postal Order may be crossed generally or specially, like a cheque.

(2) General Crossing: If the order bears across its face two parallel transverse lines, it will be paid only to a banker.

(3) Special Crossing: If the name of a bank is added between the lines, payment will be made only to that specific bank.

180-D. Period of Currency (Validity)

(1) Indian Postal Orders presented for payment within 24 months (2 years) from the last day of the month of issue are encashable without second commission.

(2) If presented after 24 months but before 36 months (3 years), they will be paid only on payment of a second commission.

(3) The second commission must be paid in the form of postage stamps affixed to the back of the order.

(4) Orders presented more than 36 months (3 years) after the last day of the month of issue shall be time-barred and will be forfeited.

🔔 STATUTORY CLARIFICATION:

Calculation of Date:

- If an IPO is issued on **15th Jan 2023**, the "last day of the month of issue" is **31st Jan 2023**.
- **First Period (No Fee):** Valid until **31st Jan 2025**.
- **Second Period (With Fee):** Valid until **31st Jan 2026**.
- **Forfeited:** After **31st Jan 2026**.

183. Payment to Public

(1) The payee must sign the order in ink in the space provided for "Received the sum of...".

(2) If the payee is illiterate, his mark or thumb-impression must be attested by a witness known to the Postmaster or identified to his satisfaction.

(3) The paying Postmaster must verify that the order is genuine, bears the date-stamp of the office of issue, and has not been altered or erased.

189. Repayment to Purchaser

(1) The purchaser of an Indian Postal Order may obtain repayment of its value (but not the commission) by presenting the order and the counterfoil at the office of issue.

(2) He must sign the receipt on the order adding the word "Purchaser" after his signature.

DATA SCHEDULE: IPO VALIDITY TIMELINE

Time from Last Day of Month of Issue	Status	Requirement for Payment
0 - 24 Months	Valid	None (Paid at face value)
24 - 36 Months	Lapsed	Second Commission (stamps on back)
> 36 Months	Time-Barred	Forfeited (Cannot be paid)

CHAPTER XI: BRITISH POSTAL ORDERS

△ OPERATIONAL ALERT (2025): The following section regarding British Postal Orders (BPO) is retained primarily for departmental examination purposes (historical syllabus).

Current Status: The sale of British Postal Orders in India has been discontinued. Encashment of valid British Postal Orders is strictly governed by current bilateral agreements and Foreign Exchange regulations, which have largely rendered this service obsolete in routine operations.

192. Sale of British Postal Orders

(1) British Postal Orders are sold at such Post Offices as may be authorised by the Director-General.

(2) They are available in denominations expressed in Sterling (e.g., 50p, £1, £5, £10, etc.).

(3) The value of the British Postal Order in Indian currency is calculated at the rate of exchange fixed by the Department from time to time.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Service Discontinuation

- The **sale** of British Postal Orders has been discontinued in Indian Post Offices.
- **Irish Postal Orders:** The sale and payment of Irish Postal Orders have also been suspended.
- Candidates should note that while the *rules* exist in the Manual, the *service* is non-operational for the public.

196. Payment of British Postal Orders

(1) British Postal Orders issued in Great Britain and Northern Ireland, or in certain British Dominions and Colonies, are paid at all Head and Sub-Post Offices in India.

(2) The amount of the order is converted into Indian currency at the rate of exchange notified by the Director-General.

(3) The order must be presented for payment within 6 months from the last day of the month of issue.

197. Conditions of Payment

(1) The payee must sign the receipt on the face of the order.

(2) If the payee is illiterate, his mark must be attested by a witness.

(3) The Postmaster must verify that the order is genuine, bears the date-stamp of the office of issue, and contains no erasure or alteration.

(4) **Stamps Affixed:** If postage stamps of the country of issue are affixed to the order to make up a broken amount, the value of such stamps (up to the prescribed limit) shall be paid.

200. Period of Currency (Validity)

(1) If a British Postal Order is presented for payment after 6 months but within 12 months from the last day of the month of issue, it may be paid only after reference to the Head of the Circle.

(2) If presented after 12 months, it is forfeited and cannot be paid without the special sanction of the British Post Office authorities.

STATUTORY COMPARISON (IPO vs. BPO):

Feature	Indian Postal Order (IPO)	British Postal Order (BPO)
First Period	24 Months (No fee)	6 Months (No fee)
Second Period	24-36 Months (With fee)	6-12 Months (With permission)
Lapsed/Void	> 36 Months	> 12 Months

CHAPTER XII: MISCELLANEOUS RULES (VOID ORDERS)

210. Void Money Orders

(1) A money order which has not been paid within the period of currency allowed by the rules (normally one year) becomes void.

(2) The amount of a void money order is credited to the Central Government.

(3) If a claim is subsequently made by the remitter or payee, the payment can only be sanctioned by the Head of the Circle (CPM/PMG) or a competent authority delegated with such financial powers.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Claims on Void Orders (Ref: Post Office Act, 2023)

- As per **Section 47** of the new Act, claims for void money orders must be made within the statutory limitation period.
- Once the amount is credited to the Government as "Unclaimed," the procedure for refund involves strict verification of the claimant's identity and the original transaction records (which are preserved for limited periods, typically 18 months for MO records).

212. Preservation of Records

(1) The journals and accounts relating to money order business must be preserved for the periods prescribed in the Postal Manual Volume VIII (Rule on Preservation of Records).

***Refer the detailed notes below.

(2) Generally, Money Order paid vouchers are preserved for 18 months.

***Postal Manual Volume VIII

(Appendix: Rules on Preservation of Records)

⚠️ ACADEMIC REFERENCE: The following retention periods are derived from Appendix A of Postal Manual Volume VIII and the Record Retention Schedule common to all Postal Circles.

Exam Tip: For Departmental Exams (IPO/PS Group 'B'), the "18 Months" rule is the most common answer for Money Order journals. However, be careful with "Bulk Lists" (6 months) and "Receipt Books" (2 years).

ANNEXURE: PRESERVATION OF MONEY ORDER RECORDS**(Ref: Rule 212 of Vol VI, Pt II & Appendix of Vol VIII)**

The journals, accounts, and books relating to Money Order business must be preserved for the periods specified below, calculated generally from the completion of the record or the close of the year to which they relate.

I. Essential Registers & Journals

Record Name	Form No.	Preservation Period
Book of MO Receipts	MO-1	2 Years
Journal of MOs Issued	MO-2	18 Months
Register of MOs Received	MO-3	18 Months
Journal of MOs Paid	MO-4	18 Months
Compilation of MOs Paid	MO-20 / MO-23	18 Months
Compilation of Daily Totals (Issued)	MO-22	18 Months
Postman's Book	MS-27	18 Months

II. Specialized Money Order Records

Record Name	Description	Preservation Period
Bulk Money Order Lists	Lists presented by remitters for bulk booking	6 Months
TMO / eMO Advice	Telegraphic/Electronic MO advice received	18 Months
Foreign Money Orders	Records of Inward/Outward Exchange Offices	3 Years
Audit Case Files	Files containing Paid MOs received from Audit	2 Years
Round Money Order Stamp	Impression Book (if maintained separately)	18 Months

III. General Accounts (Applicable to MO Branch)

Record Name	Form No.	Preservation Period
Sub-Office Daily Account	ACG-22	18 Months
Sub-Office Slip	PA-3	18 Months
Branch Office Daily Account	ACG-22 (B)	2 Years
Branch Office Slip	PA-5	2 Years
Treasury Remittance Book	ACG-8	10 Years

DIGITAL CONTEXT (APT 2.0 - 2025):

- **Physical Retention:** The periods above apply strictly to the **physical** printouts, counterfoils, and journals generated at the Post Office.

- **Digital Archives:** In the **APT 2.0** environment, transaction data (eMO booking/payment logs) is archived centrally on the server for periods often exceeding 10 years for audit trails, independent of the physical record destruction.
 - **Destruction Protocol:** No record should be destroyed without the specific order of the **Head of the Office** (Postmaster/Superintendent) after verifying that no audit objection or inquiry is pending against the relevant period.
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